

isation or individual can get someone to be patriotic. We seem to have a disregard for laws. There is some sort of attitude-building required.

KB: We're not patriotic. Maybe that's why enrollment in the armed forces is falling. Only when a cricket match is on is there some national feeling. It's shocking that we've already forgotten how tough it was to get Independence.

SL: No doubt the people who run this country are very capable. But, corruption is rife. So, my point is we

them. For example, in politics, if someone does not come from a dynasty, he has almost no chance. The least that the dynasties can do is to allow the entry of young people.

SL: In Karnataka, at least 14 MLAs have no political lineage. But in rural areas, people are selling votes. What we need is a proper plan for the next 25 years and the assurance that whichever party comes to power, they will implement that plan. If not, there has to be some sort of transparency.

VKB: We should keep the youth

away from nonsense like pubbing and rave parties. The law states that you cannot serve liquor to anyone below 21. But statistics show that 67 per cent of underage youth go to pubs. There are laws against indecent representation of women. We have to obey these laws.

KB: Since India has a significant chunk of the world's youth, the country needs to educate them and help them lead fulfilled lives. When your stomach is full, then you think about other things.



(LEFT) LAD, BHAVANI AND BALJEE; GHOSH WITH BRAGANZA

should motivate our children.

KB: There is a problem. When children from not-so-privileged families think of becoming IAS officers, it is because they want to be rich. Similarly, many people join politics to become rich, not to change the country.

AG: But you're assuming that corruption exists only among poor people.

SL: In India, whether someone is a politician or a lawyer, chances are that he is corrupt. There should be some kind of a medium to instill patriotism. We are a nation of talkers. But nothing gets us motivated.

VKB: I'll tell you where our generation is going wrong. Our people are being diverted into celebrating Valentine's Day. Recently, Barack Obama asked American children to take a cue from Indian children.

AG: One could look at our country as a union of nations. In spite of that, because of political history, we are together, which is a huge quality.

SL: How do you propose to get the youth to be more focused?

AG: By creating opportunities for

"WHEN CHILDREN FROM NOT-SO-privileged families think of becoming IAS officers, it is because they want to be rich."

KESHAV BALJEE

"WE ALL HAVE DIFFERENT IDEAS, but we should think alike at least for our country."

SANTOSH LAD

"YOUNG PEOPLE ARE BECOMING more cynical because they feel they have to be what they are in spite of the system."

ARUNDHATI GHOSH

AG: You can say everything here, but when you go back, what do you do? There is huge demand from the youth in terms of accountability. Unless that is fulfilled, they will go to another country.

CB: We are people who like to wine and dine and dance and sing. I run a place in Bangalore where people come in with families. Yet we are told that singing and dancing is banned, and in places that serve alcohol, you don't have the right to do that. It is rather strange to live in a society that is putting a restriction on a place that is licensed to do something like that. That is the change I'd like to see, a more open nation, with opportunities to go out and enjoy oneself. I think it's a question of freedom of choice.

VKB: As long as you stay within your limits.

CB: I would like to see a lot more tolerance in society, especially from a religious perspective.

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